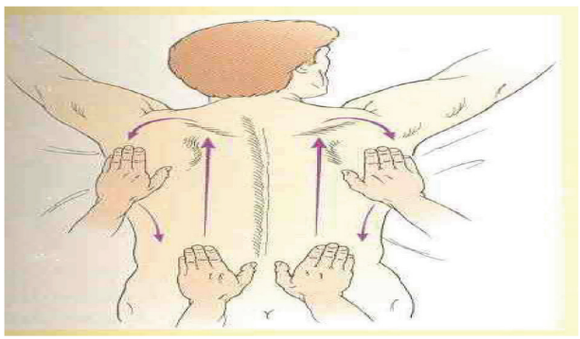
8.7.5 Massage Techniques

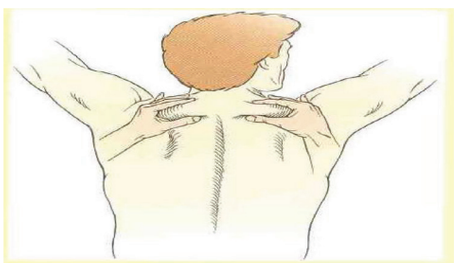
Effleurage

They are long sweeping strokes that alternate between firm and light pressure and which can be performed using the palm of the hand or the fingertips. The knots and tension in the muscles tend to get broken with this massage technique.



Petrissage

This is the technique of kneading the muscles of the body to attain deeper massage penetration. The thumbs and the knuckles of the fingers are used to knead the muscles of the body and to squeeze them to prepare them for the other massage techniques that follow.

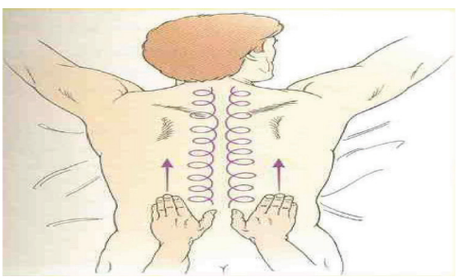


Tapotement or Rhythmic Tapping

As the name suggests, it consists of rhythmic tapping that uses the fists of the cupped hands. This helps to loosen and relax the muscles being manipulated and also helps to energize them.

Friction

This move seeks to create heat to bring about relaxation of the muscles. The palms of the hand are rubbed together vigorously with each other, or they are rubbed onto the skin of the person being massaged in order to produce heat by friction. This technique can be used as a warm up for the muscles of the body to be treated for deeper massage.



Vibration or Shaking

This helps to loosen up the muscles by using a back and forth action of the fingertips or the heel of the hand over the skin. The muscles of the body are litreally shaken up to loosen and relax the muscles.

8.7.6 Procedure

- Explain the procedure and the position to the patient.
- Adjust bed to comfortable height.
- Adjust light, temperature and sound within room.

Nursing-Gen_Chapter 08.indd 161 07/05/18 12:57 PM